It all felt grimly familiar. Israel imposed those measures in 2014, after the assault on the Har Nof synagogue that killed six people, the apex of a month of violence. It would do the same in the winter of 2015, in response to a much more sustained intifada. The violence had started, once again, with tensions on the Temple Mount. Israeli police raided the compound on 13 September, just before Rosh Hashanah; officers said they had found pipe bombs stockpiled inside the houses of worship. Several Palestinians were injured during clashes with the police, which would continue off-and-on for several days.

On 1 October, a Palestinian gunman killed an Israeli couple, Eitam and Na'ama Henkin, while they were driving between two settlements in the occupied West Bank. The couple's four young children, in the back seat of the car, survived the shooting. Two days later, a Palestinian teenager stabbed four people in the Old City, killing two. The calls for retaliation came swiftly. Netanyahu was in New York at the time, attending the United Nations General Assembly. But his mouthpiece, *Israel HaYom*, quoted an unnamed aide talking about a "second Defensive Shield", the massive military operation launched in 2002, at the height of the second intifada.

The violence continued to metastasize: another stabbing in Jerusalem, and in the southern city of Kiryat Gat; deadly clashes on the Gaza border; a Palestinian woman stopped at a checkpoint outside of Jerusalem, allegedly carrying a bomb in her car. The number of Israelis applying for gun permits jumped by a "double-digit percentage" in a matter of weeks. "Clearly we cannot assign a police officer to protect every citizen", said Erdan. "So self-defense is central and vital."

The general panic grew on 13 October, following a pair of seemingly coordinated attacks in Jerusalem. One Palestinian man attacked pedestrians with an ax after driving his car into a bus stop; two others shot and stabbed passengers aboard a municipal bus. Three Israelis were killed, raising October's death toll to seven, after more than twenty attacks. The next evening, an elderly woman was injured in a stabbing at Jerusalem's central bus station, and a separate attack was foiled near the Old City.

Once again, politicians and pundits debated what to call it, bringing about a rare agreement between Ismail Haniyeh, the Gaza-based leader of Hamas, and Isaac Herzog, the Israeli opposition leader: Both said that Israel was witnessing the start of a third intifada. "Whatever we're calling it, it's different than what we experienced in the past," said Michael Herzog, a